Soil DNA extraction, manual (SuperSoil, legacy)

Huang MEGA Lab (NCKU)
Lab plain-PDF edition, rebuilt 2026-10-21

Source of record: Huang MEGA Lab (NCKU). Originally authored on protocols.io (dx.doi.org/10.17504/protocols.io.rm7vzbzj2vx1/v1), created 2023-05-04, version 0. This PDF is the lab's self-hosted copy and supersedes the protocols.io export.

Abstract

A method for fungal and bacterial DNA extraction.

Safety warnings

1. Solution SEA and Ethanol are flammable
2. DO NOT add bleach or acidic solutions directly to the sample preparation waste.

Procedure

SAMPLE PREPARATION & CELL LYSIS

1. Add **0.2 mL** ⌀=1.0 mm zirconia beads, **0.2 mL** ⌀=0.5 mm zirconia beads, **800 µL** SD1 solution, **0.5 g** sample into a 1.5 ml microcentrifuge tube. Vortex briefly to mix.

Note If the SD1 solution is precipitated, leave it at room temperature for 30 minutes, it will become transparent again.

Note If the soil is too loose and fills up the whole microcentrifuge tube, you can separate them into 2 microcentrifuge tubes for the downstream workflow. And centrifuge 2 microcentrifuge tubes at the final step to merge them.

Note If your sample is hard to lyse, you can try the following methods:

1. After adding solution SD1, incubate at 65 °C for 10 minutes
2. Add 3 additional stainless steel beads and use 2.0 ml screw vials for your samples

2. Homogenize samples using Vortex-Genie® 2 with SI-H524 Horizontal microtube holder. Vortex at maximum speed for **4 min**

Note Be careful when removing the microcentrifuge tube from the holder. Press the lid and slowly loosen the tube with another hand.

3. Centrifuge the 1.5 ml microcentrifuge tube at **14000 rpm, 25 °C, 2 min**

INHIBITOR PRECIPITATION

4. Add **200 µL** SD2 solution to a clean 1.5 ml microcentrifuge tube.

5. Transfer **500 µL** supernatant to the tube in the previous step. Vortex **5 s** for mixing.

Note White precipitate forms.

If too much AlCl3 (CD2) is added, it will cause all the DNA to be precipitated along with the inhibitory substances.

Note If there is any suspended substance, you can use P200 and turn it to 150 µl and suck the supernatant up 3 times.

6. Centrifuge at **14000 rpm, 25 °C, 2 min**

DNA BINDING

7. Add **600 µL** SD3 solution to a clean 1.5 ml microcentrifuge tube. Avoiding the pellet, transfer up to **700 µL** of supernatant from the previous step to that tube. Vortex **5 s** for mixing.

Note If Solution CD3 has precipitated, heat at 60°C until the precipitate dissolves.

8. Take **650 µL** to spin column (with collection tube) and centrifuge at **14000 rpm, 25 °C, 2 min**

9. Discard the flow-through and repeat step 8 to ensure all the lysates have passed through the spin column.

10. Carefully place the spin column into a clean 2 ml collection tube. Avoid splashing any flow-through onto the spin column.

WASH

11. Add **500 µL** of Solution SEA to the spin column. Centrifuge at **14000 rpm, 25 °C, 2 min**

Note Solution SEA may leaks or suck back causing contamination.

12. Discard the flow-through and return the spin column to the same 2 ml collection tube.

13. Add **500 µL** 80% ethanol to the spin column. Centrifuge at **14000 rpm, 25 °C, 2 min**

Note Ethanol may leaks or suck back causing contamination.

14. Discard the flow-through and place the spin column into a new 2 ml collection tube.

15. Centrifuge at **14000 rpm, 25 °C, 3 min** Carefully place the spin column into the new 1.5 ml microcentrifuge tube

Note Ethanol can interfere with downstream DNA applications, such as PCR, restriction digests, and gel electrophoresis. Make sure to centrifuge for 3 minutes.

ELUTE

16. Add **50 µL** RNase-free water (DEPC-treated water) to the center of the white filter membrane.

Note Alternative for RNase-free water: TE(Tris-EDTA) buffer

17. Centrifuge at **14000 rpm, 25 °C, 2 min** Discard the spin column. The DNA will be in the microcentrifuge tube.

QUALITY AND QUANTITY ASSESSMENT

18. Use BioTek Take3 & Take3 Trio Microvolume Plates to measure the quality and quantity of your specimens. And then upload them to Google Drive (1 MolecularWork (Direct edit) 分生實驗號碼 (直接編輯) w_ Primer list)

Materials

#	Material
1	Bead (ball mill)
2	Solution SD1 (Chaotropic)
3	Solution SD2
4	Solution SD3 (Chaotropic)

Zirconia beads	**0.5**	**6**	**0.2**	**CAAR-ZB-0.5-1000BX**
Zirconia beads	1.0	6	0.2	CAAR-ZB-1-1000BX

	w/w
sodium thiocyanate	2.5%
Na_2HPO_4	5%
pH	~8.4

	w/w
$AlCl_3 \cdot 6H_2O$	1.5%
Ammonium acetate	25%
pH (Adjust with acetic acid)	6.3

	w/w
Guanidinium thiocyanate	65%
pH	~7.0

Solution SEA (Wash buffer 1)

	w/w
Ethanol	50%
Isopropanol	10%
Guanidine hydrochloride	30%

80% Ethanol (Wash buffer 2)

DEPC treated water (Elution buffer)